Candidates' Name: ……..……..……..

Signature: ……..……

Random Number					Personal No.		

(Do not write your school / Center name or Number anywhere on this booklet)

273/1
GEOGRAPHY
PAPER 1
JUL/AUG,2026
2 HOURS:45 MINUTES

KAMTEC EXAMINATIONS BOARD

Uganda Certificate of Education
GEOGRAPHY
Paper 1
TIME: 2 Hours and 45 minutes

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- This examination paper consists of **two** sections; **A** and **B**. It has six items.
- Section **A** has **two Compulsory** Items.
- Section **B** has **two** parts; **I** and **II.** Respond to **only one item** from each part.
- Respond to **Four** items in All.
- You may use diagrams where applicable to illustrate your responses.
- All responses **must** be written in the answer booklet(s) provided.
- Responses to each part of the item **must** be started from a fresh page.

TURN OVER

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SECTION A
(COMPULSORY)

Item 1: MAP SKILLS

For this item, refer to the **EAST AFRICA 1:50,000 (UGANDA)** map extract of **Koc**, Series **Y732**, Sheet **50/2**, Edition **1-U.S. D** provided and the text below to respond to the tasks that follow.

Koc Sub-county in Northern Uganda is largely a rural area where most people depend on natural resources such as land, water, and vegetation for their livelihoods. The area has a variety of vegetation types, relief and drainage features. In recent years, the community has experienced noticeable environmental changes, including unpredictable rainfall, longer dry periods, rise in regional temperatures and occasional flooding in low-lying areas. Some rivers that once flowed throughout the year now disappear during dry seasons, while vegetation cover has been reduced due to increased farming and tree cutting.

These changes have begun to affect agricultural productivity and water availability, raising concern among local leaders and development partners. As a result, government has recommended that citizens are educated about practical ways of conserving nature in this area and benefits that are associated. However, there is a need to first understand the climate of the area so that the proposed interventions are appropriate and sustainable. You have been selected as a panel member of the team assigned to respond to the concerns of the local leaders.

Tasks:

a) Using a suitable sketch, illustrate the physical appearance of the area.

b **(i)** Describe the likely climate characteristics of the area shown on the map extract.

ii) Basing on specific evidence from the map extract, explain to the local leaders the kind of practical ways that may be adopted in response to the government's recommendation.

Item 2. PHOTOGRAPHIC SKILLS AND USE

Wakiso is a growing region in terms of its population and economic activities. Many people in this area have started to encroach on the fragile ecosystems like forests, uplands and wetlands which has attracted attention and concern among local leaders. In order to reduce pressure on the natural resources, the local leaders have requested government to relocate a portion of the population elsewhere. Government has promised to move selected groups of people to Kapsinda village in Eastern Uganda. Most of the families chosen to be relocated are excited about the dense forests, forested rocky hills, variety of streams flowing through wetlands in this village which they plan to exploit through charcoal burning, and hunting, stone quarrying and upland cultivation, intensive fishing and papyrus harvesting.

Their happiness has been cut short by the government's warning against such practices. You have been hired by the government to educate the relocated people about how their planned activities may affect the quality of the environment and their lives in the new location.

Support Material



TASK

a) Describe the Natural diversity of the area

b) With evidence from the photograph taken from Kapsinda village, prepare the kind of information you would use to address the relocated people.

SECTION B

PART I

Attempt **one** item from this section

Item 3

During the first term holidays last year, your class undertook a field study tour to parts of Kasese District. During the tour, you traversed a vast, generally hot, flat-floored depression marked by prominent inward-facing fault scarps, forming a striking and unique physical landscape.

As you moved across this area, you observed that it was sparsely populated, with many of the residents living in poorly constructed housing and many could not explain how it came into existence. Despite the harsh conditions, the landscape exhibited several natural features that indicated the presence of valuable resources with potentials for improving the livelihoods of the local community.

Following the tour, your teacher has organized an inter-school essay competition aimed at sensitizing the local community about the existence of the unique landscape in their environment and proposing ways in which resources with it can sustainably be utilized to improve their standards of living. You have been selected to represent your school.

Task:

a). Using your knowledge of landforms in East Africa, explain to the members of the community how the landscape you observed during the field study was formed.

b.) Suggest ways the community members can sustainably utilise the feature to generate wealth and improve their livelihoods.

ITEM 4

Across Africa, Rivers such as the Nile, Niger, and Zambezi transport large volumes of sediments from their upper courses to lower regions. Over time, these sediments are deposited in areas where the velocity of the river decreases, leading to the development of distinct depositional landforms. In some places, extensive triangular features composed of fine alluvial material are formed at river mouths, while in others, gently sloping cone-shaped deposits of unsorted rock boulders and gravel develop at the base of highland slopes

Recent geographical studies indicate that although these features are widespread and significant, there is limited understanding among communities about the natural processes responsible for their formation. This has raised concern among environmental planners and geographers who seek to promote better awareness of these landforms.

You have been assigned duty to prepare an awareness note that will be used in the sensitization campaigns organized by the Uganda Tourism Board.

Tasks:

a) Identify and explain the mode of formation of the two distinct features described in the scenario above.

b) Propose the various ways of utilizing the above-described features for sustainable development.

PART II

Attempt one item from this part

Item 5.

Across many parts of East Africa, rapid urban growth has brought both opportunity and strain on the natural environment. In Kampala, areas that were once covered with wetlands such as Nakivubo Wetland have been encroached on for industrial development, housing, and waste disposal. Similarly, in Nairobi, sections of the Nairobi River have become heavily polluted due to poor waste management and industrial discharge. In Dar-es-Salaam, coastal mangrove forests that once protected the shoreline have been cleared for urban construction and fuel, increasing the risk of erosion and flooding. As these cities continue to expand, concerns are rising among stakeholders about the long-term sustainability of urban life, especially as natural resources that once supported these urban centres are steadily being depleted.

A regional conference on urban planning has been organized in East Africa, bringing together city planners, environmentalists, and local leaders. During the meeting, concern is raised that many urban centres in the region are losing their natural resources such as wetlands, clean air, forests, and clean water sources. Evidence is presented showing environmental degradation in cities like Kampala, Nairobi, and Dar-es-Salaam.

You have been selected as a youth representative to present ideas on how urban centres can continue to grow while protecting their natural environment.

Table 1.0: Size of selected urban centres in East Africa in hectares from 2000 to 2020.

CITY	2000	2010	2020
KAMPALA	25,000	39,000	62,000
NAIROBI	42,000	68,000	103,000
DAR ES SALAAM	57,000	85,000	125,000

Adapted: Atlas of urban expansion Org- New York University (2022).

Tasks:

a) Use a suitable graph to represent the above information.
b) Prepare the kind of presentation you would use to address concerns of the city planners, environmentalists and local leaders.

ITEM 6.

In 2025, the African Union organized a continental dialogue following growing concern about Africa's international trade patterns. Media reports showed that although African countries export goods worth millions of dollars to Europe, they import even more high-value manufactured goods, making Europe appear to benefit more from the relationship.

Local traders, small-scale manufacturers, and students across different African countries have strongly criticized this imbalance. In public discussions, many pointed out that Africa mainly exports raw materials such as coffee, minerals, and agricultural products, while importing expensive finished goods like machinery and vehicles. Some stakeholders have therefore suggested that African countries should shift their trade focus toward China, which they believe may offer better opportunities.

In response to these concerns, the African Union has organized a sensitization campaign targeting traders and the general public across member states. You have been invited as a resource person to help participants in exploring the nature of the Africa–Europe trade relationship and guide them on how African countries benefit from this trade relationship.

Table; 1. 0. Trade patterns between Africa and Europe from 2018 to 2022

YEARS	**Africa's Exports to Europe in Billion USD**	**Africa's Imports from Europe in Billion USD**
2018	120	180
2020	110	200
2022	140	220
TOTAL	**370**	**600**

Adapted: African Development Bank Afro-Europe trade indicator Tasks

a) Use the base map provided below to represent the flow of Exports and imports across Africa and Europe.
b) Make a write up describing the kind of guidance you would give to the traders and general public in the campaign where you are invited.

Cut and Hand-in the Base map page of the item paper if you attempt this item.



END